

RESEARCH ARTICLE

Emotional intelligence and boundary-spanning behavior among door-to-door salespeople

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Abstract

This study examines the impact of emotional intelligence (EI) on boundary-spanning behavior, relationship quality, and performance among door-to-door salespeople. Data is collected from salespeople and customers of South Korean door-to-door cosmetics businesses and analyzed using structural equation modeling. The findings show that EI positively affects boundary-spanning behavior. Similarly, boundary-spanning behavior improves relationship quality, which improves both sales performance and customer satisfaction. This suggests that EI plays an important role in salespeople's boundary-spanning behavior, thereby enhancing relationship quality, sales performance, and customer satisfaction. Unlike previous studies, this study makes use of actual sales volumes, salespeople's self-reporting responses, and salespeople's customer-reporting, which adds to the findings' uniqueness. The present study highlights that EI improves boundary-spanning behavior, which is vital in developing relationship quality, improving sales performance, and increasing customer satisfaction. The study uses triadic data from door-to-door salespeople, customers, and sales organizations extensively, which is unusual in this field.

KEYWORDS

boundary-spanning behavior, emotional intelligence, Korean cosmetic industry, performance, relationship quality

Résumé

La présente étude porte sur l'impact de l'intelligence émotionnelle sur les comportements d'ouverture, la qualité des relations et la performance des vendeurs en porte-à-porte. Les données sont collectées auprès de vendeurs et de clients de commerces de cosmétiques en porte-à-porte en Corée du Sud et sont analysées à l'aide d'un modèle d'équation structurelle. Il ressort de l'étude que l'intelligence émotionnelle a un effet positif sur le comportement d'ouverture. Ce comportement améliore la qualité des relations, ce qui augmente à la fois les performances de vente et la satisfaction des clients. Ces conclusions laissent penser que l'intelligence émotionnelle joue un rôle important dans le comportement d'ouverture des vendeurs, améliorant ainsi la qualité des relations, les performances de vente et la satisfaction des clients. Contrairement aux études précédentes, la présente étude s'appuie sur des volumes de vente réels, des réponses autodéclarées par les vendeurs et des réponses fournies par les

clients, ce qui en renforce l'originalité. La présente étude souligne que l'intelligence émotionnelle améliore le comportement d'ouverture, ce qui est essentiel pour développer la qualité des relations, améliorer les performances de vente et accroître la satisfaction des clients. L'étude utilise largement les données tri-adiques des vendeurs en porte-à-porte, des clients et des organisations de vente, ce qui est inhabituel dans ce domaine.

MOTS-CLÉS

comportement d'ouverture, industrie coréenne des cosmétiques, intelligence émotionnelle, performance, qualité des relations

JEL CLASSIFICATION

M14, M16, M48

1 | INTRODUCTION

Salespeople have been regarded as boundary spanners in almost every type of business organization due to the frontline roles they play. Salespeople, for instance, interact with customers in both business-to-business (B2B) and business-to-consumer (B2C) settings (Shin et al., 2021; Wisker & Poulis, 2015). Salespeople also play an important role in representing the organization to outsiders (including customers) and enhancing the firm's image and legitimacy through their advocacy of the firm and its products and services (Yi & Amenuvor, 2022). Moreover, due to their boundary-spanning roles, salespeople have numerous opportunities to share information internally about changing customer needs and potential improvements in service delivery. Besides, salespeople have numerous opportunities to share information internally about changing customer needs and potential improvements in service delivery due to their boundary-spanning roles. Furthermore, salespeople's delivery behaviors such as courtesy, personal attentiveness, responsiveness, and keeping promises significantly affect customer satisfaction and service quality perceptions. These emphasize the importance of boundary-spanning behavior in meeting the needs of both the customer and the organization.

Even though salespeople's boundary-spanning role has a significant impact on both the company and customers, there appear to be some research gaps in the field. First, previous research has paid little attention to assessing how salespeople's emotional intelligence (EI) influences their out-of-role behavior (such as boundary-spanning behavior), which is especially important because they deal directly with customers and across departments. Emotional intelligence is defined in this context as the ability or proclivity to perceive, comprehend, regulate, and harness emotions in oneself and others in an adaptive manner (Lassk & Shepherd, 2013).

For instance, in a study that examined the antecedents of adaptive selling behavior, Amenuvor et al. (2021b) discovered that EI positively influences salespeople's adaptive selling behaviors. However, adaptive selling behavior is deemed to be theoretically distinct from the boundary-spanning behaviors investigated in this study. This is premised on the fact that adaptive selling behaviors are in-role behaviors, whereas boundary-spanning behaviors are out-of-role behaviors. Accordingly, our study extends previous research by contending that, in addition to adaptive selling behavior, salespeople's EI can influence their boundary-spanning behaviors.

Similarly, Wisker and Poulis (2015) discovered in their study on "EI and sales performance" that EI is an important predictor of adaptive selling behavior. In their study on "Clarifying the influence of EI on salesperson performance," Kadic-Maglajlic et al. (2016) found that two focal types of selling behaviors—adaptive selling and customer-oriented selling—fully mediate the positive relationship between EI and salesperson performance. As intimated earlier, the salesperson behaviors examined in their study differ from the boundary-spanning behaviors investigated in this study.

Consequently, while some studies on EI and its outcomes have been conducted, it appears that these outcome behaviors have primarily been in-role behaviors and do not reveal that EI can influence out-of-role behaviors like the boundary-spanning behaviors examined in this study. More so, previous research shows a paucity of studies determining the effects of salespeople's boundary-spanning behaviors on customers' perceived relationship quality. In addition, it appears that extant studies have not done enough in assessing the impact of customer perception of relationship quality on both customer satisfaction and sales performance. Equally, insufficient research has been conducted in the context of door-to-door cosmetics sales (Amenuvor et al., 2021a; Yi,

Cha, & Amenuvor, 2021). These are gaps in the literature that require scholarly attention.

Accordingly, this study attempts to fill these gaps by investigating the effect of EI on boundary-spanning behavior of door-to-door salespeople. We argue that salespeople's EI, particularly in the context of door-to-door selling, can have a significant impact on their out-of-role boundary-spanning behaviors. We note that because boundary-spanning behavior is similar to organizational citizenship behavior, EI is required for engineering and maneuvering these prosocial behaviors. Prosocial behavior is typically linked to the concept of socially desirable behavior in organizations because there are cultural expectations that people should engage in prosocial behavior because it is socially acceptable or proper in some way (Amenuvor et al., 2022; Baruch, 2004; Boateng et al., 2022). The current study also investigates the effects of boundary-spanning behavior on relationship quality. We assert that a salesperson's service performance (activities such as ascertaining consumer needs and complaints, as well as actively caring for customers) may have a greater impact on relationship quality. Finally, we investigate how the quality of relationships affects both customer satisfaction and sales performance.

The current research specifically addresses the following questions: What effect does EI have on salespeople's boundary-spanning behaviors? While scholars like Wisker and Poulis (2015) have argued that salespeople's EI improves their adaptive selling behavior, our study advances their work by arguing that salespeople's EI improves their overall boundary-spanning behaviors (including external presentation behavior, internal influence behavior, and service delivery behavior), which are out-of-role behaviors, rather than just adaptive selling behavior; What effect does boundary-spanning behavior have on relationship quality? For instance, previous studies that attempted to investigate salespeople's boundary-spanning behavior (Bettencourt & Brown, 2003) did not highlight the critical dimensions and how each of these dimensions could lead to enhancing relationship quality; What is the effect of relationship quality on sales performance and customer satisfaction? Previous research (for example, Kadic-Maglajlic et al., 2016) attempted to investigate these relationships but only examined EI, relational selling behavior, and salesperson performance. Our research, however, investigates the effect of EI on multidimensional boundary-spanning behavior and relationship quality, and assesses how the latter predicts both sales performance and customer satisfaction.

In effect, we show that EI influences salespeople's out-of-role behaviors, such as boundary-spanning behaviors, and that these boundary-spanning behaviors improve customer satisfaction and sales performance via

relationship quality. Additionally, because most previous salesperson performance studies have limitations due to salesperson self-reporting (Peterson et al., 2020), this study uses actual sales performance data of individual door-to-door salespeople, customer reporting of salespeople, and salespeople's self-reporting responses. This novel approach to data collection and analysis is a crucial starting point for this research.

The current study provides managers with a solid foundation for making strategic decisions about how to instill and enforce EI in salespeople. This study will also guide managers and salespeople on how to effectively play their boundary-spanning roles, as it proposes that boundary-spanning behaviors can lead to improvements in the quality of customer-salesperson relationships. More so, the findings of this study could aid in the design of training and professional development programs, as well as selection and recruitment criteria.

2 | THEORETICAL BACKGROUND AND LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 | Emotion regulation theory

The emotion regulation theory (Gross, 1998) is the theoretical lens through which this study is viewed. The broad theory of emotion regulation that we apply in framing our research defines the processes by which people control which emotions they feel, when they feel them, and how they feel and express these emotions (Gross, 1998). Controlling emotional arousal and the cognition that causes emotions enables a person to tailor their emotional expressions to the social context. To do so, a person must be able to observe, evaluate, analyze, and control complex emotions while adhering to the display rules of the situation. Gross's (1998) input-output model of emotion regulation states that one receives stimulus and information from a specific situation and then responds with emotions and behaviors. Individuals in this proposed paradigm have two options: (1) regulate their own emotional appraisal, or (2) modify and change physiological or observable emotional signals.

Relational selling behaviors (which include the boundary-spanning behaviors discussed in this study) are a salesperson's behavioral proclivity to establish and maintain buyer-seller relationships, which require higher levels of emotion regulation (Guo & Ng, 2012). Bagozzi's (1992) goal-oriented action theory provides a solid foundation for explaining why salespeople with EI and high emotion regulation ability engage in relational selling behaviors. The theory asserts that when attempting to achieve a goal, people research and select the tools they

believe will be the most effective: “In the presence of a purpose to pursue a goal, decisions are made with respect to methods” (Bagozzi, 1992, p. 196). The personal selling context is especially advantageous to salespeople with high EI since it allows them to observe their customers’ reactions to messages and make immediate modifications (emotion regulation) (Kadic-Magljalic et al., 2016).

Indeed, emotion regulation abilities are also beneficial in gathering customer feedback. Hence, the interactive nature of selling increases salespeople’s motivation to use their unique emotion regulation skills (Kadic-Magljalic et al., 2016). Relational selling activities that occur with any sort of customer relationship are ideal for converting emotion regulation abilities into effective selling tools and meeting sales targets. Reading customers’ emotions gives salespeople information that helps them comprehend the desires of their consumers. Furthermore, emotion regulation assists salespeople in their boundary-spanning tasks by modifying their behaviors with their exchange partners. The knowledge gained through emotion regulation enables salespeople to provide relevant solutions to consumers’ needs. This logic holds that translating emotion regulation into pro-customer boundary-spanning behaviors (e.g., external representation behavior, internal influence behavior, service delivery behavior) helps salespeople achieve favorable results, which leads to improved relationship quality.

2.2 | Emotional intelligence (EI)

Emotional intelligence is defined by Wong and Law (2002) and Mayer et al. (1999) as a set of interconnected skills that includes the ability to accurately perceive, appraise, and express emotion; the ability to access and/or generate feelings that facilitate thought; the ability to comprehend emotion and emotional knowledge; and the ability to regulate emotions to promote emotional and intellectual growth. Mayer et al. (1999) and Wong and Law (2002) have also conceptualized EI as having four distinct dimensions: Self emotional appraisal, which refers to an individual’s natural ability to understand and express their deep emotions; others’ emotional appraisal, which refers to people’s ability to perceive and understand the emotions of those around them; regulation of emotion, which refers to people’s ability to control their emotions, allowing for a faster recovery from psychological distress; use of emotion, which refers to people’s ability to channel their emotions into constructive behavior.

In this study, we apply the following interrelated skills to operationalize EI: understanding self-emotion, understanding others’ emotions, emotional control, motivating

emotion, and relationship maintenance (Goleman, 1995). Understanding self-emotion refers to a salesperson’s ability to analyze and evaluate his or her own emotions to form emotional knowledge. Understanding other people’s emotions refers to a salesperson’s ability to analyze and evaluate the emotions of others to gain emotional knowledge. Emotional control is a salesperson’s ability to control their emotions (Salovey & Mayer, 1990). It is concerned with how the salesperson influences which emotions they experience, when they experience them, and how they experience or express them (Gross, 1999). It also includes the ability and knowledge to strategically control and change the emotional experiences of others (Cote, 2014). Emotional control, in effect, represents a salesperson’s ability to control one’s own and others’ emotions to achieve a desired outcome (Mayer & Salovey, 1997).

In addition, motivating emotion, which is closely related to self-motivation, refers to the salesperson’s ability to accept responsibility for his or her performance, self-control, achievement drive, and commitment to the organization’s goals (Pettijohn et al., 2010). Because salespeople are frequently unsupervised, this is an important aspect of EI. Hence, we argue that motivating emotion is essential for many aspects of sales, particularly the salesperson’s boundary-spanning behavior. Finally, relationship maintenance refers to a salesperson’s ability to nurture a one-of-a-kind relationship with customers and other stakeholders. We contend that the ability of salespeople to establish and maintain long-term relationships with customers and other stakeholders reflects their EI (Aurier & N’Goala, 2010).

Table 1 presents a summary of key findings from previous research on EI. As can be gleaned from Table 1, studies pertaining to EI have revealed mixed findings. While some studies find that salespeople’s EI influences their adaptive selling behaviors (Amenuvor et al., 2021b), others have found that it can lead to determining the level of salespersons’ performance (Brown, 2014). Similarly, others also found that EI of managers could significantly be related to the perception of group cohesiveness among salespeople (Wilderom et al., 2015), while others found that it could promote team trust (Barczak, et al., 2010), creativity (Lassk & Shepherd, 2013), and customer orientation scores (Pettijohn et al., 2010). However, though these previous studies have revealed varying, yet interesting findings, it is conspicuous how previous research have been silent on how EI could enhance salespeople’s boundary-spanning behaviors (external representation behavior, internal influence behavior, and service delivery behavior) and how these affect relationship quality, sales performance and customer satisfaction, a contribution which the current research sets out to make.

TABLE 1 Emotional intelligence (EI) and selling: a summary of key studies

Source	Antecedents	Mediators	Moderators	Outcomes	Data	Emotional Intelligence Related Findings
Chen and Jaramillo (2014)	Adaptive selling		Emotional Intelligence	Salesperson owned loyalty to the service providerWord-of-Mouth	Dyadic data from customers (150) matched with salespeople (25) who work for a large financial institution in Chile.	EI affects customer outcomes through a progressive structure that involves its dimensions: emotion perception precedes use of emotion, which in turn leads to emotion regulation
Amenuvor et al. (2021b)	Emotional Intelligence			Adaptive selling behavior	$n = 219$ salespeople and their visiting customers in selected cosmetics companies in Korea	Salespeople's emotional intelligence positively influences their adaptive selling behaviors
Brown (2014)	Transformational LeadershipEmotional Intelligence			Sales performance	Conceptual Paper	Both transactional and transformational leadership styles and the level of emotional intelligence acuity can affect and determine the level of salespersons' performance.
Wisker and Poullis (2015)	Emotional Intelligence	Adaptive Selling Behavior		Sales performance	Data were collected from salespeople in the financial industries in Malaysia via the WLEIS emotional intelligence scale and ADAPTS adaptive selling behavior scale and were quantitatively analyzed using structural equation modeling (SEM).	Emotional intelligence impacts sales performance via adaptive selling behavior
Wilderom, Hur, Wiersma, Van Den Berg, and Lee (2015)	Manager's Emotional Intelligence	Store Cohesiveness		Sales-directed Employee behaviorObjective store performance	$n = 1611$ sales employees; 253 sales managers in South Korea	Manager EI is significantly related to the perceptions of group cohesiveness among the stores' staff.

TABLE 1 (Continued)

Source	Antecedents	Mediators	Moderators	Outcomes	Data	Emotional Intelligence Related Findings
Barczak et al. (2010)	Emotional Intelligence		Cognitive TrustAffective Trust	Collaborative CultureCreativity	<i>n</i> = 82 student teams, a large university in the northeast United States	EI promotes team trust
Lassk and Shepherd (2013)	Emotional Intelligence			Salesperson CreativityJob satisfactionJob performance	<i>n</i> = 460 independent B2C sales representatives, health and beauty industry	EI positively influences job satisfaction and job performance.EI positively influences salesperson's creativity
Kadic-Maglajic et al. (2016)	Emotional Intelligence	Adaptive Selling BehaviorCustomer-oriented selling behavior (COSB)		Salesperson Performance	Two data sets from business-to-business salespeople in various industrial and service sectors were analyzed with structural equation modeling.	Adaptive selling and customer-oriented selling – fully mediate the positive relationship between emotional intelligence and salesperson performance
Pettijohn et al. (2010)	Emotional IntelligencePositive affectivityNegative affectivity			Customer Orientation	<i>n</i> = 71 pharmaceutical salespeople working in the UK	Salesperson EI levels are positively related with their customer-orientation scores.
Delprechitre, Beeler-Connelly, and Chaker (2018)	Salesperson Emotional IntelligenceEmpathy			Citizenship BehaviorCommitment to the salesperson	<i>n</i> = 224 business-to-business salespeople and their customers	Salesperson EI and empathy affect customer participation, customer citizenship behavior, and commitment to the salesperson

2.3 | Boundary-spanning behavior

Both the services marketing/management literature and the boundary-spanning literature emphasize three vital aspects of frontline service employees' customer-linking activities that contribute to market-driven organizational capacity and resource development (Day, 1994). First, they play an important role in representing the company to outsiders (including consumers) and strengthening the firm's image and legitimacy by promoting the company's products and services (Booms & Bitner, 1981; Bowen & Schneider, 1985). Second, service employees' boundary-spanning role enables them to exchange information internally about changing customer needs and potential service delivery enhancements (Schneider & Bowen, 1984; Zeithaml et al., 1988). Third, frontline service delivery characteristics such as courtesy, personal attentiveness, responsiveness, and keeping promises have significant impacts on customer satisfaction and service quality perceptions (Parasuraman et al., 1988).

Drawing on the foregoing, we investigate three types of boundary-spanning behaviors that salespeople may engage in that are associated with connecting the organization to its potential or actual customers (Bettencourt & Brown, 2003): (1) External representation behavior, which refers to being vocal advocates for the organization's image, products, and services to outsiders (Booms & Bitner, 1981); (2) internal influence behavior, which refers to taking individual initiative in communicating with the firm and coworkers in order to improve service delivery by the organization, coworkers, and oneself (Zeithaml et al., 1988); and (3) service delivery behavior, which refers to providing customers with conscientious, responsive, attentive, and courteous service (Parasuraman et al., 1988). These three key behavioral dimensions will be used in the current study to explicate boundary-spanning behaviors, which we argue are key outcomes of salespeople's EI and antecedents of relationship quality, sales performance, and customer satisfaction.

3 | CONCEPTUAL MODEL AND HYPOTHESIS DEVELOPMENT

The emotion regulation theory fits well with the study's conceptual model. When gathering customer feedback, emotional regulation abilities (which represent EI) are useful. The interactive nature of selling encourages salespeople to employ their distinct emotion regulation abilities (Kadic-Magljajic et al., 2016). Relational selling activities with any type of customer relationship are ideal

for transforming emotion regulation abilities into effective selling tools and meeting sales targets. For instance, reading customers' emotions provides salespeople with information that helps them understand their customers' desires. Moreover, emotion regulation aids salespeople in their boundary-spanning tasks by modifying their interactions with their exchange partners. Additionally, the knowledge gained through emotion regulation enables salespeople to provide relevant solutions to consumers' needs (which is achieved in their boundary-spanning roles). According to this logic, translating emotion regulation into pro-customer boundary spanning behaviors (e.g., external representation behavior, internal influence behavior, service delivery behavior) helps salespeople achieve favorable results, which leads to improved relationship quality and, consequently, sales performance and customer satisfaction. The specific nexuses among the constructs are discussed further below.

3.1 | Emotional intelligence and boundary-spanning behavior

Emotional intelligence has been operationalized as the ability to perceive, understand, and regulate emotions to facilitate buyer-seller interactions (Delpechitre et al., 2018). Emotional intelligence, for instance, has been identified as a key moderator of critical salesperson-performance relationships (Chen & Jaramillo, 2014) and as a key to salesperson success (Delpechitre et al., 2018); however, much remains unknown about the direct effects of EI on salespeople's boundary-spanning behavior. Previous studies used a three-dimensional approach, such as perceiving emotions, understanding emotions, and regulating emotions (Amenuvor et al., 2021b; Delpechitre et al., 2018). Others have defined EI in terms of five competencies (self-awareness, self-regulation, self-motivation, empathy, and social skills) (Pettijohn et al., 2010). Consequently, we conceptualize EI from the following perspectives: understanding self-emotion, understanding others' emotions, emotional control, motivating emotion, and relationship maintenance, and argue that EI will improve salespeople's boundary-spanning behavior. Based on previous discussions on EI traits, we argue that these skills and traits appear to describe a salesperson with a greater ability to engage in boundary-spanning behavior, because such an individual would be focused on the long term, understand his/her own emotions and that of others, control his/her emotions, is emotionally motivated, and has the ability to maintain relationships. Following from our initial classification of

boundary-spanning behavior into external representation behaviors, internal influence behaviors, and service delivery behaviors, we propose the following hypotheses:

H1 *Emotional intelligence will positively and significantly affect:*

- (a) External representation behavior.
- (b) Internal influence behavior.
- (c) Service delivery behavior.

3.2 | Boundary-spanning behavior and relationship quality

As previously stated, salespeople play a critical role in representing the firm to its stakeholders (including customers) and enhancing the firm's image through effective advocacy and communication about the firm's products and services (Bowen & Schneider, 1985; Shin et al., 2021; Yi, Cha, & Amenuvor, 2021). Furthermore, salespeople's boundary-spanning behaviors provide them with numerous opportunities to share information internally about changing customer needs and potential improvements in service delivery (Schneider & Bowen, 1984; Zeithaml et al., 1988). Besides, because salespeople demonstrate high levels of courtesy, personal attentiveness, and responsiveness, among other things (Betten-court & Brown, 2003), customers are more likely to perceive high levels of relationship quality. Parasuraman et al. (1988) note that service quality perceptions are heavily influenced by frontline employees' (e.g., salespeople) service delivery behaviors (which are basically boundary-spanning behaviors).

Accordingly, we maintain that, based on the previous discussions on boundary-spanning behaviors, each of the boundary-spanning behaviors will improve the quality of the relationship between customers and salespeople. Thus, we contend that external representation behavior, internal influence behavior, and service delivery behavior will all have respective positive effects on relationship quality, and advance the following set of hypotheses:

H2 *External representation behavior will have a positive and significant effect on relationship quality.*

H3 *Internal influence behavior will have a positive and significant effect on relationship quality.*

H4 *Service delivery behavior will have a positive and significant effect on relationship quality.*

3.3 | Relationship quality and sales performance

Relationship quality reflects how satisfied buyers are with the overall relationship over time, as demonstrated by product quality, service quality, price paid for value received, and the degree to which the relationship functions as a partnership (Huntley, 2006). There appears to be a scarcity of research on the nexus between relationship quality and salesperson performance. Even though Park and Deitz (2006) investigated the relationship between relationship quality and salesperson performance, their study focused on the relationship between salesperson and sales managers rather than the buyer-seller relationship.

Crosby et al. (1990) proposed that sales effectiveness be related to relationship quality; however, their findings did not support that hypothesis. Similarly, Park et al. (2010) asserted that relationship quality should lead to improved sales performance because it focuses on developing long-term relationships between buyers and sellers. Our research looks at how the quality of relationships between buyers and sellers affects actual sales performance. There has been very little previous research into this relationship (Huntley, 2006). Thus, we posit that relationship quality will improve actual sales performance. The relative paucity of research on the subject, combined with the preceding insights, lead to the following hypothesis:

H5a *Relationship quality will have a significant positive effect on sales performance.*

3.4 | Relationship quality and customer satisfaction

The essence of relationship marketing is encapsulated by relationship quality (Smith, 1998). Relationship marketing incorporates relationship quality, which explains a company's attempt to build a deep and cost-effective relationship with their customers (Allaway et al., 2006). To this end, Yang et al. (2010) surmise that it is an important consideration when explaining a company's relationship with its customers. Relationship quality explains a company's proximity to its customers (Hennig-Thurau, 2000).

Besides, relationship quality has been considered as a package of intangible value that improves products or services and results in an anticipated exchange between customers and salespeople (Levitt & Levitt, 1986). In a broader sense, relationship quality describes the overall depth and climate of a relationship (Johnson, 1999). It also captures customers' perceptions of how well the

overall relationship meets the customer's expectations, predictions, goals, and desires (Amenuvor et al., 2019; Jarvelin & Lehtinen, 1996). Accordingly, it influences a customer's overall perception of the relationship, including various transactions.

Customers, for instance, assess salespeople based on their ability to deliver the lowest price, defect-free products, and superior customer service, among other factors that contribute to their level of satisfaction. Satisfaction is thus a value-based evaluation that focuses on the tangible attributes of the relationship. Hence, we contend that the quality of relationships within the contexts of buyer-seller relationships can influence customer satisfaction. Even though previous research has paid little attention to establishing this link, this study contends that the degree to which customers perceive quality in their relationships and interactions with salespeople has a positive impact on their level of satisfaction. Therefore, we proffer the following hypothesis:

H5b *Relationship quality will have a significant positive effect on customer satisfaction.*

These hypotheses and relationships are represented in Figure 1 below.

4 | EMPIRICAL RESULTS

4.1 | Measurement of variables

As part of a quantitative research approach, structured questionnaires were used in the current study. Using this method allows for the estimation of actual statistical measurements of theorized hypotheses on empirical data (Hair et al., 1998). The variables were measured using a five-point Likert scale, with 1 indicating “strongly disagree,” 5 indicating “strongly agree,” and 3 indicating

“neutral.” EI was measured using the above-mentioned second-order constructs of understanding self-emotion, understanding others' emotions, emotional control, motivating emotion, and relationship maintenance. The items used to measure EI were adapted and modified from Mayer and Salovey (1993) and Goleman (1995). The items used to assess boundary-spanning behavior were adapted from Bettencourt and Brown (2003). Items adapted from Palmatier et al. (2007) and Yi, Cha, and Amenuvor (2021) were used to measure customer satisfaction. Items from DelVecchio (1998) were used to assess relationship quality. Actual three months' average sales volume of each door-to-door salesperson is used to assess sales performance (Yi, Cha, & Amenuvor, 2021). Although the original questionnaire was written in Korean, all variables were translated into Korean from earlier research written in English. To verify translation equivalence, a professional translator and two research assistants who are US nationals independently translated the questionnaire into English and then back into Korean (Dubinsky et al., 1997). They reviewed the independently translated Korean versions of the items and came to a consensus on the final version of the questionnaire. The questionnaire was then pilot tested with 200 consumers who were not included in the main survey. We discovered preliminary evidence that the scales were reliable and valid.

The scale items and their respective factor loadings are presented in Appendix 1.

4.2 | Samples and data collection

To test the hypotheses, a questionnaire was distributed to 219 door-to-door salespeople from two different cosmetics companies that operate door-to-door sales channels and are ranked first and second in the South Korean cosmetics market. Additionally, in the South Korean cosmetics market, personal selling channels account for the second

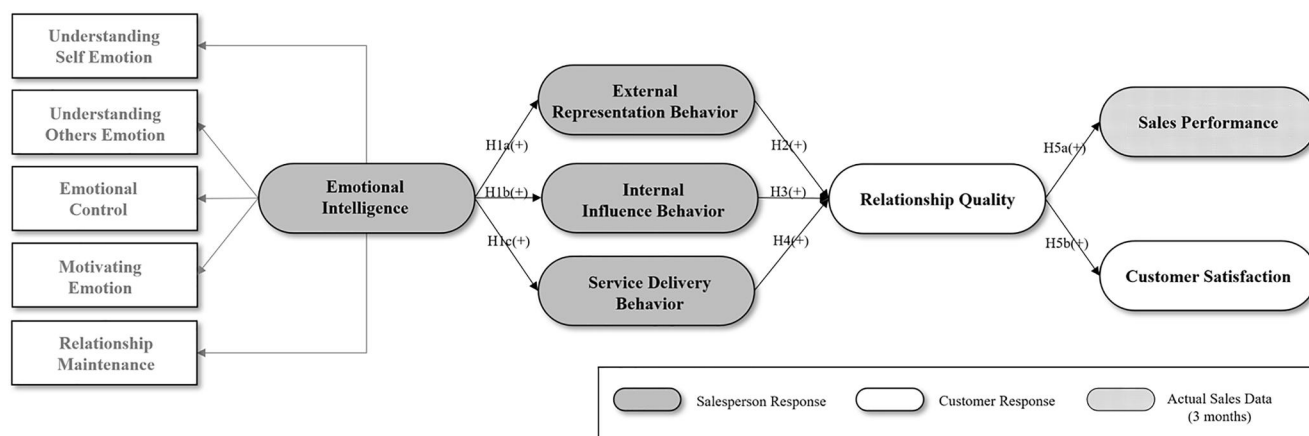


FIGURE 1 Conceptual Framework.

highest proportion of sales after online shopping, making it an ideal market for studying the effects of personal sales. Purposive sampling was used to select the door-to-door salespeople and customers from the Daegu-Gyeongbuk Regional Headquarters. We used this sampling technique because we only wanted to choose door-to-door cosmetic salespeople and customers in South Korea. Face-to-face data collection took place from August to December 2021. The survey took a little longer than expected because it was necessary to match the cosmetic door-to-door salesperson, the consumer survey for customers who purchased cosmetics from the door-to-door salesperson, and the cosmetic door-to-door salesperson's 3-month average sales performance.

Because door-to-door salespeople do not receive a base salary and are not required to report to the office, questionnaires were distributed during monthly training sessions. Respondents agreed to participate in the study after the research objectives were clearly explained to them. They were instructed to distribute questionnaires and collect the questionnaires from the first customer they encountered in exchange for free coffee coupons. Respondents who entered their cell phone numbers received coffee coupons. In the case of salespeople, in particular, the cell phone number was used as an ID in matching the sales performance data of the salespersons over the last 3 months with the responses of each salesperson.

We settled on data from various sources to reduce the likelihood of bias, and due to the peculiarity of the data. For example, we were persuaded that for a construct such as EI and (the dimensions of) boundary-spanning behaviors, it is best for salespeople to respond to these comments because they directly apply to them. Second, for a construct like relationship quality, we believe that because the customer is on the receiving end of service delivery, they will be better judges of the quality of relationship they have with the salespeople. Finally, rather than asking salespeople to respond to questions about sales performance (as done in most studies), we used a 3-month actual sales data. This was intended to reduce bias and present actual figures rather than salespeople's responses. Though these are data from three different sources, we encountered no problem in our data analysis.

Our research builds on previous studies that used triadic data from various sources. For example, Kraus et al. (2015) used data from Managers/Salespeople, Customers, and Objective data in their study on "When sales managers and salespeople disagree in the appreciation for their firm: The phenomenon of organizational identification tension." Similarly, in their study on "When should the customer really be king", Homburg et al. (2011) used data from three different sources including salesperson

data, sales manager data and customer data. Likewise, Palmatier et al. (2007) in their study on "Customer loyalty to whom? Managing the benefits and risks of salesperson-owned loyalty" drew on triadic data from buyers, salespeople, and sales managers. Equally, in their study that assessed "Service orientation and customer performance: Triad perspectives of sales managers, sales employees and customers, Yi et al. (2022) used triadic data from sales managers, sales employees, and customers.

Table 2 shows the characteristics of door-to-door salespeople and customers who responded to the questionnaire.

4.3 | Test for non-response bias

In keeping with Armstrong and Overton (1977), we tested for nonresponse bias by comparing early and late respondents' work experience, job position, education, and company name. Second, we looked for differences between the variables used in the two groups of this study. There were no statistically significant differences ($p < 0.05$) found in either case.

4.4 | Common method bias

The authors used two approaches in the study to reduce the possibility of common method bias. First, the authors collected data for the independent and dependent variables from three different sources (Podsakoff et al., 2003). Customers filled out the sections on relationship quality and customer satisfaction, while salespeople filled out the sections on EI and boundary-spanning behavior. We used 3-month actual sales data to evaluate sales performance. Second, the authors considered the possibility of single-factor analysis for all items (Podsakoff & Organ, 1986). The first factor accounted for 36.093% of the variance; consequently, no single factor appeared, and no factor accounted for the majority of the variance.

4.5 | Reliability and validity test

Cronbach's Alpha was used to confirm the reliability of the measurement items through internal consistency, confirmatory factor analysis (CFA) was used to ensure its validity. Because all the measured variables had Cronbach's alpha values of at least 0.8, internal consistency was established. The CFA produced the following fit indices: $\chi^2 = 1037.333$, d.f. = 670, $\chi^2/\text{d.f.} = 1.548$, RMR = 0.024, RMSEA = 0.050, GFI = 0.815, NFI = 0.852, IFI = 0.942, TLI = 0.935, CFI = 0.941. The adjusted chi-

TABLE 2 Profile of respondents

Classification		N	%	Classification		N	%
Salesperson Age	30–39 years	13	6.0	Previous Work Experience	Self-Employment	71	32.5
	40–49 years	50	22.8		Housewife	123	56.2
	50–59 years	119	54.3		Office Worker/Sales Worker	25	11.4
	Above 60 years old	37	16.9	Reason for Joining This Company	Company/Product Image	61	27.8
Working Periods	1-under 3 years	15	6.8		Company's Marketing Capability	34	15.5
	3-under 5 years	42	19.2		Friend Recommendation	124	56.6
	5-under 7 years	92	42.0	Transaction Period With This Salesperson (Customer response)	Less than 1 year	13	5.9
	Above 7 years	70	32.1		1-under 2 years	19	8.7
Rank	Junior/Senior	97	42.9		2-under 3 years	21	9.6
	Master	92	42.0		3-under 4 years	20	9.1
	Chief Master	33	15.1		4-under 5 years	9	4.1
					5-under 6 years	14	6.4
Education	Less than High School	71	32.4		6-under 7 years	19	8.7
	College/University	61	27.8		Above 7 years	104	47.5
	Graduation School	87	39.7				

square value symbolizes the change in degree of freedom as a function of increment or decrement and should be less than 3 to satisfy the overall degree of fit. The RMR is less than 0.05, whereas the GFI, NFI, IFI, TLI, and CFI are mostly greater than 0.90. In effect, the theoretical model's overall fit to the factors identified in this study could be confirmed (Kline, 1998). Both the standardized loading values and the AVEs exceeded the required cut-off points of 0.50, emphasizing the centralized validity (Bagozzi & Yi, 1988). Table 3 illustrates this.

To ensure discriminant validity, we looked at whether the square of the correlation coefficients between constituent constructs was less than the AVE. The squared values of all correlation coefficients met this criterion, confirming that overall discriminant validity was guaranteed. Furthermore, to determine the direction of the hypotheses, a correlation analysis was performed between all variables used in this study. The findings indicated that the variables in the hypotheses were generally significantly correlated, and the direction of the correlation was also generally significant (Fornell & Larcker, 1981). These are shown in Table 3 and Table 4.

4.6 | Model fit and hypothesis test

The structural equation modeling technique was used to test the hypotheses (specifically with AMOS version 25).

In terms of the analysis results, a model: $\chi^2 = 1462.718$, d. f. = 712, $\chi^2/\text{d.f.} = 2.054$, RMR = 0.075, RMSEA = 0.070, GFI = 0.762, NFI = 0.793, IFI = 0.882, TLI = 0.869, CFI = 0.880 was developed. This model is thought to be appropriate in comparison to the general evaluation indicators of structural analysis of covariance. Table 4 shows the results of the path coefficients set in this study as well as the verification results of the respective research hypotheses. Emotional intelligence was positive and significantly related each to external representation behaviors ($\beta = 0.274$, $t = 3.206$, $p < 0.05$), internal influence behaviors ($\beta = 0.22$, $t = 2.639$, $p < 0.05$), and service delivery behaviors ($\beta = 0.273$, $t = 3.213$, $p < 0.05$) respectively in support of hypotheses H1a, H1b, and H1c. Similarly, the study found a significant positive relationship between external representation behaviors and relationship quality ($\beta = 0.268$, $t = 4.369$, $p < 0.05$), significant positive relationship between internal influence behaviors and relationship quality ($\beta = 0.157$, $t = 2.742$, $p < 0.05$), and a significant positive relationship between service delivery behaviors and relationship quality ($\beta = 0.773$, $t = 8.340$, $p < 0.05$), in support of hypotheses H2, H3, and H4 respectively. Furthermore, the study found a significant positive effect of relationship quality on customer satisfaction ($\beta = 0.854$, $t = 9.082$, $p < 0.05$) and a significant positive effect of relationship quality on sales performance ($\beta = 0.176$, $t = 2.338$, $p < 0.05$), in support of hypotheses 5a and 5b respectively. In effect, as

TABLE 3 Measurement model

Measurement item		construct	st. estimate	S.E.	C.R.	AVE	CR	Cronbach's α
2nd order construct	Motivating Emotion	Emotional Intelligence	.740	.136	6.517	0.540	0.854	0.925
	Understanding Self Emotion		.716					
	Understanding Others Emotion		.822	.101	8.137			
	Emotional Control		.764	.127	6.931			
	Relationship Maintenance		.618	.107	5.949			
Understanding Self-Emotion			.865			0.671	0.890	0.891
			.892	.056	16.984			
			.783	.061	13.928			
			.726	.067	12.474			
Understanding Others Emotion			.723			0.621	0.866	0.863
			.800	.101	11.266			
			.901	.104	12.344			
			.713	.099	10.061			
Emotional Control			.859			0.688	0.868	0.868
			.848	.065	14.552			
			.779	.068	13.105			
Motivating Emotion			.761			0.636	0.839	0.835
			.794	.073	11.389			
			.835	.082	11.881			
Relationship Maintenance			.746			0.631	0.872	0.868
			.868	.089	12.573			
			.830	.088	12.079			
			.726	.099	10.514			
Construct			st. estimate	S.E.	C.R.	AVE	CR	Cronbach's α
Service Delivery Behaviors			.773			0.592	0.879	0.889
			.754	.082	11.47			
			.827	.080	12.856			
			.751	.084	11.491			
			.740	.085	11.278			
External Representation Behaviors			.760			0.642	0.878	0.888
			.811	.064	15.556			
			.818	.081	12.233			
			.815	.080	12.194			
Internal Influence Behaviors			.733			0.666	0.888	0.893
			.797	.080	13.927			
			.864	.102	12.598			
			.862	.101	12.575			
Relationship Quality			.747			0.707	0.905	0.910
			.742	.069	14.189			

(Continues)

TABLE 3 (Continued)

Construct	st. estimate	S.E.	C.R.	AVE	CR	Cronbach's α
	.927	.082	14.309			
	.928	.082	14.323			
Customers Satisfaction	.837			0.709	0.907	0.905
	.816	.064	14.471			
	.885	.055	16.427			
	.829	.063	14.842			

Model fit: $\chi^2 = 1037.333$, d.f. = 670, RMR = .024, RMSEA = .050, GFI = .815, NFI = .852, IFI = .942, TLI = .935, CFI = .941.

TABLE 4 Descriptive statistics and correlations analysis

Construct	Mean	st.d.	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)
Emotional Intelligence (1)	3.6498	.43803	1						
Internal Influence Behaviors (2)	3.8790	.57785	0.108	1					
External Representation Behaviors (3)	3.9635	.55782	0.115	0.770**	1				
Service Delivery Behaviors (4)	4.0438	.53458	0.150*	0.720**	0.653**	1			
Relationship Quality (5)	4.1427	.55790	0.143*	0.568**	0.522**	0.685**	1		
Customer Satisfaction (6)	3.4874	.65631	0.487**	0.075	0.052	0.106	0.065	1	
Sales Performance (7)	15.1314	.62355	0.372**	0.139*	0.103	0.156*	0.187**	0.172*	1

** $p < 0.01$; * $p < 0.05$.

TABLE 5 Structural model and assessment results

H	Path	st. estimate	S.E.	C.R.	P	Result
H1a	Emotional Intelligence → External Representation Behaviors	.274	.100	3.206	.001	Supported
H1b	Emotional Intelligence → Internal Influence Behaviors	.220	.082	2.639	.008	Supported
H1c	Emotional Intelligence → Service Delivery Behaviors	.273	.092	3.213	.001	Supported
H2	External Representation Behaviors → Relationship Quality	.268	.048	4.369	.000	Supported
H3	Internal Influence Behaviors → Relationship Quality	.157	.053	2.742	.006	Supported
H4	Service Delivery Behaviors → Relationship Quality	.773	.078	8.340	.000	Supported
H5a	Relationship Quality → Customer Satisfaction	.854	.123	9.082	.000	Supported
H5b	Relationship Quality → Sales Performance	.176	.115	2.338	.019	Supported

Model fit: $\chi^2 = 1462.718$, d.f. = 712, RMR = .075, RMSEA = .070, GFI = .762, NFI = .793, IFI = .882, TLI = .869, CFI = .880.

shown in Table 5, all hypotheses set in the current study were supported.

5 | SUMMARY AND CONCLUSIONS

5.1 | Discussion of findings

The current study investigates the effects of EI on boundary-spanning behavior, relationship quality, sales performance, and customer satisfaction in the context of door-to-door selling. Generally, the study finds that

salespeople's EI is germane to their boundary-spanning behavior. Specifically, the study finds that EI positively and significantly effects external representation behavior, internal influence behavior, and service delivery behavior respectively. Though these findings are not widespread in the existing literature, it lends support to some previous scholars' (Sony & Mekoth, 2016) contention that EI can positively influence frontline employees' (including salespeople) adaptability (of which actions may be reflected in boundary-spanning behavior). These findings also corroborate Amenuvor et al. (2021b) claim that EI is important for salespeople's selling behaviors. Hence, our

findings make a compelling case for the importance of EI in salespeople's ability to engage in boundary-spanning behaviors.

Similarly, the current study discovers a significant positive relationship between (all dimensions of) boundary-spanning behavior and relationship quality. This means that external representation behavior, internal influence behavior, and service delivery behavior respectively have a positive and significant effects on relationship quality. Though it appears that previous research has not paid much attention to these nexuses, it supports the claim made by some scholars (Bettencourt & Brown, 2003) that because salespeople in their frontline roles demonstrate high levels of courtesy, personal attentiveness, and responsiveness, among other things, during boundary-spanning behaviors, customers may have a proclivity of perceiving high levels of relationship quality. These results also emphasize the position that salespeople's boundary-spanning behaviors provide them with many opportunities to share information internally about evolving customer needs and potential improvements in service delivery (Schneider & Bowen, 1984; Zeithaml et al., 1988), implying that customers' specific needs will be met, thereby improving the quality of the relationship. Our findings support the notion that when salespeople perform boundary-spanning roles, they improve their relationships with customers, and customers, in turn, perceive high levels of relationship quality. We posit that these findings are important in light of the shift in emphasis from transactional selling to developing and maintaining strategic and life-long customer relationships.

This study also discovers a significant positive relationship between relationship quality and sales performance. This finding supports Park et al.'s (2010) assertion that because relationship quality focuses on developing long-term relationships between buyers and sellers, it should lead to improved sales performance. Consequently, this study proposes that relationship quality is a key predictor of sales performance.

Finally, the current study uncovers that relationship quality has a significant positive effect on customer satisfaction. Though this outcome is not common in the existing literature, it lends support to the argument that relationship quality is built through the establishment of trust with exchange partners, satisfaction with exchange partners, and commitment to ongoing relationships (Dorsch et al., 1998), all of which lead to satisfaction. Our study reinforces the stance that when salespeople focus on building quality relationships with customers through boundary-spanning activities, it leads to increased customer satisfaction.

In effect, this study augments existing knowledge by bolstering the notion that salespeople's boundary-

spanning behaviors are influenced by their EI to a greater extent. The study accentuates the point that boundary-spanning behaviors by salespeople lead to relationship quality, which improves both sales performance and customer satisfaction. While these findings are distinct from previous research, the fact that they were obtained from the door-to-door sales channel and among cosmetic salespeople and customers emphasizes its uniqueness.

5.2 | Theoretical implications

Salespeople frequently engage in boundary-spanning behavior in their service delivery due to the nature of their jobs, particularly with the intent of providing solutions to customers and other stakeholders (Mensah & Amenuvor, 2022; Yi, Yeo, et al., 2021). Despite this, a few research appears to exist in the sales literature that integrates and investigates the relationships among the constructs used in this study. Previous research examined the relationships between these variables separately or in combination with other constructs (Delpechitre et al., 2018; Pettijohn et al., 2010), highlighting the need for new empirical analysis, validation, and theory development. Similarly, this study significantly contributes to theory by assessing several interdependencies among the variables used and using data from door-to-door cosmetics sales channels.

Moreover, the current study appears to be the first to link EI to boundary-spanning behaviors and how these lead to relationship quality building, as far as the authors are aware. Though previous studies assessed outcomes of EI (Chen & Jaramillo, 2014; Wisker & Poulis, 2015), they discovered, among other things, salesperson owned loyalty, sales performance, adaptive selling behavior, collaborative culture, and affective trust, as outcomes of EI. The current study, however, goes beyond these previous studies and finds that salespeople's EI can predict multidimensional boundary-spanning behaviors (including external representation behavior, internal influence behavior, and service delivery behavior). Hence, our study contributes to theory by extending the outcomes of EI to include salespeople's multidimensional boundary spanning behaviors.

Our study also uniquely contributes to theory by finding that salespeople's (multidimensional) boundary-spanning behaviors engender relationship quality between salespeople and customers. Accordingly, salespeople who effectively carry out their boundary-spanning behaviors could build quality and enduring relationships with customers. Thus, this study progresses both the sales management and relationship quality literature by

finding that (multidimensional) boundary-spanning behaviors are key predictors of relationship quality.

The current study further contributes to theory by finding that relationship quality leads to sales performance and customer satisfaction (Park & Deitz, 2006). The uniqueness of these outcomes is premised on the fact that data was collected from three different data sources (salespeople, customers, and actual sales data). Consequently, this study advances theory and extends knowledge by finding these outcomes using triadic data. This allows us to explicate how customers and salespeople perceive each other's roles in the exchange relationship.

5.3 | Practical implications

The study's strategic findings can help salespeople and managers develop and implement policies. The following significant points of view can be used to evaluate the study's key findings: that EI has a significant positive effect on external representation behavior, internal influence behavior, and sales delivery behavior; that each of these behaviors improves relationship quality; and that relationship quality has a significant positive effect on sales performance and customer satisfaction.

Trying to evaluate the performance of salespeople in missionary sales positions is a difficult task because many exogenous variables influence performance. Among these are economic factors, competition, marketing expenditures, pricing, product availability, new product development, product quality, and governmental regulations. In these cases, evaluating the performance of door-to-door cosmetics salespeople is difficult because common performance metrics, such as sales volume and profitability, may obscure several of the salesperson's valuable activities and efforts. Consequently, when it is difficult to measure salesperson effectiveness, businesses may rely on surrogate indicators, such as salespeople's boundary-spanning behaviors (external representation behavior, internal influence behavior, and sales delivery behavior). Previous research has found a link between boundary-spanning behavior and salesperson performance, as previously mentioned. When consultative selling is required, it has been stated that salespeople's boundary-spanning behavior is crucial. Also, because of the unusual nature of the products marketed, these scenarios are typically characterized by long buying cycles, group selling, and a greater emphasis on the customer's well-being. These descriptors appear to describe the roles of a door-to-door cosmetics salesperson. Hence, the discovery that EI is significantly and positively related to (all dimensions of) boundary-spanning behavior is intriguing.

Emotional intelligence is a trait/characteristic/skill that can be developed and improved through training. This implies that cosmetics companies seeking to improve the boundary-spanning behaviors of their salespeople, particularly door-to-door salespeople, should engage in activities aimed at increasing the salespeople's EI levels. Furthermore, given that EI can be developed through strategic training, we propose that EI levels be taken into account during the selection process. While firms can increase EI levels through training, we argue that higher entry levels of EI can lead to better outcomes through selection and training. To that end, the firm may select individuals with high levels of EI and then continue to improve these skills through training, resulting in high levels of boundary-spanning behaviors.

Our study also discovered that boundary-spanning behavior improves relationship quality, which is largely determined by the salesperson's customer service approach. This is because salespeople with more engaging customer service skills are more likely to form a positive connection with customers during the sales process. Understanding how salespeople's boundary-spanning behavior improves relationship quality and, eventually, sales performance and customer satisfaction should guide managers when making implementation and sales team composition decisions. Because the study discovered that external representation behavior, internal influence behavior, and sales delivery behavior all improve relationship quality, it suggests that, to improve relationship quality, salespeople (boundary-spanners) should be directed toward a greater emphasis on sharing explicit and tacit information with stakeholders, effectively communicating with external and internal stakeholders, and providing and inducing cooperative behavior. This is especially true for cosmetics door-to-door sales, which require a variety of customer relationship strategies.

5.4 | Limitations and future research direction

We believe that our findings have contributed to the body of knowledge, but we acknowledge that no study is perfect, and we hope that ours will serve as a starting point for future research. To begin with, this study used a sample from a specific industry (the cosmetics industry); therefore, future research should attempt using samples of salespeople and customers from various South Korean industries to validate these findings. Korea's culture is collectivist in nature, and this reflects on its people; thus, cultural distinctiveness may influence the findings. We also believe that the unique characteristics of Korean culture may either strengthen or weaken the

interrelationships between the mean scores on the various variables (likewise, for different salesperson compensation strategies). Hence, the findings are limited to this context, and managers and researchers should exercise caution when applying them to other contexts.

Second, statistical analysis revealed that some model fit indices fell below the cut-off value. As a result, it will be necessary in future research to review various previous studies to improve the model's fit and develop more sophisticated questionnaires based on this. Future research should aim to increase the sample size to improve the generalizability of the findings. Similarly, the constructs studied can be applied to a wide range of economic situations, so these findings should pique researchers' interest in the phenomenon at hand, particularly the apparent discrepancies between EI and behavioral outcomes. Finally, future research that introduces and evaluates mediating variables like customer commitment/loyalty may reveal whether, for instance, the relationship between relationship quality and sales performance can be mediated by customer commitment/loyalty. Similarly, future research that incorporates a moderating variable such as customer orientation into the model, could reveal whether the relationship between boundary-spanning behavior and relationship quality, for example, can be moderated by the salespeople's customer orientation.

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APPENDIX 1 Scale items

Items	Factor Loadings
Understanding self-emotion	
When I experience a positive emotion, I know how to make it last.	.865
I am aware of my emotions as I experience them.	.892
I have control over my emotions.	.783
I easily recognize my emotions as I experience them.	.726
Understanding others Emotion	
By looking at their facial expressions, I recognize emotions people are experiencing.	.723
I am aware of the nonverbal messages other people send.	.800
I know what other people are feeling just by looking at them.	.901
I can tell how other people are feeling just by listening to the tone of their voice.	.713

(Continues)

APPENDIX 1 (Continued)

Emotional Control

I try not to feel disappointed even if the situation is bad.	.859
I usually reconcile first when there is an argument.	.848
I try to calm myself when my mood is bad.	.779

Motivating Emotion

I motivate myself by imagining a good outcome to tasks I take on.	.761
When I feel a change in emotions, I tend to come up with new ideas.	.794
I use good moods to help myself keep trying in the face of obstacles.	.835

Relationship Maintenance

I arrange events others enjoy.	.746
When I am in a positive mood, solving problems is easy.	.868
I compliment others when they have done something well.	.830
When another tells me about an important event in his or her life, I almost feel as if I experienced the event myself.	.726

Relationship Quality

I am emotionally attached to this salesperson.	.747
I have intimacy with the salesperson.	.742
I think the salesperson I meet is honest.	.927
I believe the salesperson I meet is trustworthy.	.928

Customer Satisfaction

The amount of contact I have had with this salesperson was adequate	.837
I am satisfied with the level of service this person has provided.	.816
I am happy doing business with this salesperson.	.885
In general, I am pretty satisfied with my dealings with this salesperson.	.829